

Setting Up the T-Pot Honeypot

This document outlines the step-by-step process I took to deploy a T-Pot honeypot platform on a webhosted server, including the troubleshooting steps required to resolve any issues I ran into along the way.

The first phase involves setting up the virtual environment and preparing the operating system for the T-Pot installation.

1. **VPS Provisioning:** I chose Vultr to by my webhosting services.
2. **Network Security:** I then configured the Vultr firewall to allow necessary traffic while securing the backend.

Action ↑↓	Protocol ↑↓	Port / Range ↑↓	Source ↑↓
Accept	TCP	1:65535	0.0.0.0
Accept	UDP	1:65535	0.0.0.0
Accept	TCP	64294:64297	32.216[REDACTED]

3. **Remote Access:** I proceeded to establish a connection to the server using SSH from my PC.
4. **User Management:** Because T-Pot does not let you run the command to clone the github repo in root mode I had to create another user without root privileges

```
sudo adduser Logan
```

5. **Repository Cloning:** I then navigated to the home directory and cloned the official T-Pot Community Edition repository from GitHub:

```
cd /home/Logan
```

```
git clone https://github.com/telekom-security/tpotce
```

During the installation process, I repeatedly ran into an error:

```
TASK [Get distribution name (All)] *****
[ERROR]: Task failed: Premature end of stream waiting for become success.
>>> Standard Error
sudo: interactive authentication is required
Origin: /home/Logan/tpotce/installer/install/tpot.yml:13:7

11
12   tasks:
13     - name: Get distribution name (All)
      ^ column 7

fatal: [127.0.0.1]: FAILED! => {"changed": false, "msg": "Task failed: Premature end of stream waiting for become success.\n>>> Standard Error\nsudo: interactive authentication is required"}

PLAY RECAP *****
127.0.0.1      : ok=0    changed=0    unreachable=0    failed=1    skipped=0    rescued=0    ignored=0

### Something went wrong with the Playbook, please review the output and / or install_tpot.log for clues.
### Aborting.
```

The Issue:

The installer failed with a Premature end of stream error, indicating that sudo required interactive authentication which the automated playbook could not provide:

To resolve this, I removed the password requirement in the sudoers file, allowing the playbook to execute tasks with root privileges without a password prompt.

Verification:

After the fix, the installer completed successfully. I verified the status using `systemctl status tpot`, confirming that the T-Pot services and Docker containers were active.

```
root@Loganshoneypot:~# systemctl status tpot
● tpot.service - T-Pot
   Loaded: loaded (/etc/systemd/system/tpot.service; enabled; preset: enabled)
   Active: active (running) since Wed 2026-06-24 22:54:12 UTC; 1h 35min ago
 Invocation: 55ec63d168b84b3c80b8f0b4f9179a1a
   Process: 23902 ExecStartPre=/usr/bin/docker compose -f /home/Logan/tpotce/docker-compose.yml down -v (code=exited,
 Main PID: 23929 (docker)
    Tasks: 21 (limit: 6227)
   Memory: 70.1M (peak: 84.5M, swap: 11.8M, swap peak: 14.5M)
      CPU: 8.252s
   CGroup: /system.slice/tpot.service
           └─23929 /usr/bin/docker compose -f /home/Logan/tpotce/docker-compose.yml up
             └─23949 /usr/libexec/docker/cli-plugins/docker-compose compose -f /home/Logan/tpotce/docker-compose.yml up

Jun 25 00:29:47 Loganshoneypot docker[23949]: honeytrap | Loading plugin SaveFile v1.0.1
Jun 25 00:29:47 Loganshoneypot docker[23949]: honeytrap | Loading plugin logattacker v1.0.2
Jun 25 00:29:47 Loganshoneypot docker[23949]: honeytrap | Loading plugin logjson v1.1.0
Jun 25 00:29:47 Loganshoneypot docker[23949]: honeytrap | Servers will run as user honeytrap (2000).
Jun 25 00:29:47 Loganshoneypot docker[23949]: honeytrap | Servers will run as group honeytrap (2000).
Jun 25 00:29:47 Loganshoneypot docker[23949]: honeytrap | Loading default responses.
Jun 25 00:29:47 Loganshoneypot docker[23949]: honeytrap | Connections will be handled in normal mode by de
Jun 25 00:29:47 Loganshoneypot docker[23949]: honeytrap | Logging to /opt/honeytrap/var/log/honeytrap.log.
Jun 25 00:29:47 Loganshoneypot docker[23949]: honeytrap | Core module initialized.
Jun 25 00:29:49 Loganshoneypot docker[23949]: map_data | 2026-06-25 00:29:39 | Brazil | 45.20
```

Despite this, I could not get into the webGUI no matter what I tried. I spent over an hour restarting the servers, configuring the firewall, etc. to figure out what the problem was. After a ton of back and forth with Claude I figured out that the problem was that the SSL

certificates that nginx were expecting got corrupted during the initial download and did not work.

The Fix:

To restore access, I generated a fresh set of SSL certificates.

1. Create Certificate Directory:

```
sudo mkdir -p /home/Logan/tpotce/data/nginx/cert
```

2. Generate New Certificates:

The following openssl command was used to create a self-signed certificate valid for 365 days:

```
sudo openssl req -x509 -nodes -days 365 -newkey rsa:2048 \
-keyout /home/Logan/tpotce/data/nginx/cert/nginx.key \
-out /home/Logan/tpotce/data/nginx/cert/nginx.crt \
-subj "/C=US/ST=State/L=City/O=Organization/OU=Unit/CN=localhost"
```

3. Set Permissions:

Permissions were updated to ensure the Nginx container could read the files:

```
sudo chmod -R 777 /home/Logan/tpotce/data/nginx/cert
```

4. Restart Services:

```
sudo systemctl restart tpot
```

Final Result

After applying the SSL fix, the WebGUI finally worked, giving me access to the honeypot's monitoring dashboards and attack data.



